

The Future of Work is No Work: A Call to Action for Designers in the Abolition of Work

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ABSTRACT

We endure decades of preparation for, enduring of, and recovery from work. It manifests and corrupts most of our life. It doesn't have to be like this. We can envision and design towards a future that gives life back to us: a world without work as we know it. HCI as a field should be oriented towards abolishing work for everyone rather than designing a future of work, often depicted as a metaverse of three-dimensional avatars, virtual workplaces, and automated oppression. In this paper, we detail what work is, what the abolition of work means, and a call to action for HCI to abolish work following a transformative justice framework.

CCS CONCEPTS

• **Human-centered computing** → Human computer interaction (HCI); HCI theory, concepts and models; • **Social and professional topics** → Professional topics; Computing profession; Computing occupations.

KEYWORDS

Abolition of Work, Design, Future of Work, Prefigurative Design

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1 INTRODUCTION

1930s economist Richard Keynes predicted a 15-hour work week by 2030 [66]. In 2021, we're still working 9-5. Where's the leisure society predicted by futurists of the 20th century? If our technological advancements can free us from scarcity, why is work still dominating us [47, 77, 78]?

Work has been gaining attention as a topic of inquiry. Arguments criticizing work ideology, visions of postwork futures, and claims for UBI abound. How do we actually abolish work and what's the HCI community to do in the meantime? This paper will explore work, the abolition of work, and a framework for practitioners to contribute to the abolition of work.

The authors assume an anticapitalist, anarchist stance [65]. This paper does not contend to hold the ultimate solution to all systemic

problems, but to contribute to the conversations around work, problematizing design, the abolition of work, and designers' roles in dismantling work.

2 WHAT IS WORK?

Work is a "linguistic chameleon": everyone knows what you mean despite their own dynamic model of work [71]. This paper will use post-left anarchist Bob Black's definition of work: compulsory productive activity enforced by economic or political means, "by the carrot or the stick" [13].

Work means waged work: performed to make money by producing outputs for the profit that can be extracted from them. This also includes work that's in service of capital but not legally or socially valued as work (sex work, unpaid internships, housework, etc.). Work also broadly includes the protestant work ideology: viewing work as inherently good.

Work is different from what can be defined as effort, being creative, being useful, or being productive. Anything that's done outside of enforced economic or political means is not work (e.g., playing games, caring for others, chatting with friends). By refusing work and reorienting our productive energy away from work, we can refocus it on socially useful and liberatory activities that aren't economically or politically forced. A refusal of work isn't advocating for people to do nothing all day. It's a belief that work represses basic realizations of personal and social existence: self-actualization, social bonds, autonomous activity, leisure, play, idleness, and laziness [13, 42].

A life without work is unthinkable. Imagine having every day of your life to do exactly what you want: spending time with your kids, doing projects with your local community, building loving, mutual relationships with others and the environment, etc. That's what's at stake. Every day wasted on work is a day not living that life.

Instead, work takes up most of our time. We wake up to commute, spend 8 hours (often more) doing tasks our managers tell us to do for wages, fill forms, speak corporate, commute home exhausted, and spend the remaining amount of our time recovering and preparing for the next day of work [18, 42, 50, 64]. We spend more time with our "work families" than our actual families, leading to more conflict in our "free time" (especially prevalent in remote workers) [33].

The workplace is, as Kathi Weeks deliberates, "the site of many of the most palpable and persistent relations of domination and subordination that people confront, even if these are not conventionally perceived as potentially alterable enough to be regarded as properly political matters." [109].

Work is dehumanizing. There is a widespread shaming of people who are excluded from work (e.g., disabled, elderly) [26]. Work is often a space for social inclusion, excluding already marginalized

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communities [26]. It's further dehumanizing in giving up our time and energy to production, whether or not you want to [107].

Work kills us. Deaths from working range from commuting accidents to deadly workplace incidents [13]. We're killed from the toxic effects of stress from work, pollution, occupational injuries, sedentary lifestyles, drug use to cope with work, and overworked lifestyles [13]. We often burnout from the stress of workplace demands, leading to debilitating anxiety and depression [96]. This death rate is incalculable.

Finally, working doesn't even guarantee you'll be able to live life with the necessities. Once you've reached a certain age or amount of capital, social acceptability of not working presents itself ("retirement" or being wealthy). After spending most of your waking hours at work, given the vigor of your body and mind to work, you can finally relax [42]. Not so fast! Didn't have the luxury to save enough through a 401k type scheme, make an absolute fortune, and/or get a pension? You'll be taking an odd job or two on your way out [22, 112].

What's the point [48]? Why not abolish work?

3 THE ABOLITION OF WORK

"No one should ever work. Work is the source of nearly all the misery in the world. Almost any evil you'd care to name comes from working or from living in a world designed for work. In order to stop suffering, we have to stop working." [13]

We'll use Bob Black's "The Abolition of Work" as a reference to the direction for the abolition of work [13]. Black has two directions to abolish work: reducing the amount of work being done and transforming subsistence work into play. Black notes that just 5% of the work being done would satisfy our basic needs. As David Graeber relates, many jobs today are "bullshit jobs": they have no social usefulness or meaning for the individuals performing them [51]. Most work serves the unproductive means of commerce or social control [13, 42]. The abolition of work is a social problem, not a technological or automation problem [47].

Black calls for a new form of life based on the opposite of work: play [13]. This is living the life you want, voluntarily, with joy. However, we'll still need subsistence work to survive. This work needs to be turned into play. Subsistence work needs to be structured to take advantage of what different people at various times enjoy. People have different interests that can be used towards collective benefit. In Black's vision, work will be a "pleasing variety of game-like and craft-like pastimes, indistinguishable from other pleasurable pastimes, except that they happen to yield useful end-products" [13].

Black is averse and skeptical of AI and automation to achieve a postwork world. We share this skepticism, but also believe that automation will look much different than how it does now. Currently, automation rarely benefits workers and has yet to liberate us from work. Instead, workers are at odds against each other once they're laid off [17]. Specific workflows may be automated, but labor as a commodity remains: people must keep working, at some other job or doing something else at their current one [25]. While technology changes, social conditions don't. Automation and AI often don't reduce the number of hours anyone has to work. As Judy Wajcman

notes, "we live in an acceleration society in which technological acceleration produces not more leisure and downtime, but in fact an ever-faster pace of life" [110].

Automation often disguises human labor rather than emancipating it (e.g., self-check-out counters). This mirage is especially persistent in AI systems. Much of the work done by AI is veiled human labor whereupon a handful of companies control resources and labor from a planetary wide enterprise [24, 53, 95, 108]. These AI systems are often unsustainable in use and further harm marginalized communities [1, 10, 105]. AI development will continue to propagate exploitation of human labor and extraction of earth's resources [24, 97]. Automation thus far has yet to yield liberation from work: only intensification of work [81, 82].

Automating every job is unsustainable since many jobs don't contribute to any social necessity, instead producing commodities [51]. As automation increases, worker power may decrease. While AI, capitalism, and work are almost always portrayed as unavoidable and necessary, we must put our efforts against these realisms [41, 82]. McQuillan rightly warns us that, "AI provides a generalizable, technocratic method for reducing profound social questions to optimization problems. Like bureaucracy in the twentieth century, AI is poised to become the unifying logic of legitimization across corporations and government." [83].

We believe efforts in automation should be reserved for socially necessary tasks (e.g., healthcare, dangerous work). Imagine if we all shared a collective duty of the necessary dirty work: we could automate it with combined efforts. What determines whether something is a social necessity worthy of automation or not? This needs to be continually negotiated and reexamined, rather than calcifying in automation. As McQuillan continues, "We don't need autonomous machines but a technics that is part of a movement for social autonomy and liberation" [83].

4 DESIGN'S ROLE IN WORK

"The ultimate, hidden truth of the world is that it is something that we make, and could just as easily make differently." [50]

While we need to be destroying work, we also need to be creating infrastructures to support the abolition of work as prefigurative politics [16]. Those of us who are privileged enough to be paid and legitimized as designers are vested in this type of work [60, 90]. However, human-centered design as we practice it must be abolished. We're designers of work and workflows, crafters of the systems and interfaces to capitalist structures of violence. We must shift to creating prefigurative politics against work [49]. This means activities that express the 'ends' of its politics through its 'means', both envisioning a future without oppression and putting action into the present moment to create that future [6, 85].

4.1 Bon Voyage, Human-Centered Design!

Bad news for designers: human-centered design (HCD) is not human-centered, it's capital-centered. If it's human-centered, it's centered around venture capitalists. The user is only a means to advance the company's ends: make more cash and defeat competitors. Designers often intend to do good, however, there is little good to do within our current system [75].

Both technology and production practices have politics [15, 106, 111]. As Lily Irani points out, design is a “practice that implies certain social orders. . . between those who make progress and those who follow” [60]. Those social orders are largely in service of work. Design has been complicit with environmental degradation caused by the production of an excess of consumer goods and the spreading of colonialism [7, 31, 62]. As Sasha Costanza-Chock elaborates, “design reproduces, is reproduced by, and/or challenges the matrix of domination (white supremacy, heteropatriarchy, capitalism, and settler colonialism)” [23].

As noted by many scholars problematizing design, we must shift our politics. Akama et al. defines this precisely, “. . . de-couple design from its modern, industrialized roots so that it can be re-situated and re-conceptualized as a method, approach, mindset, and ontology, centrally grounded in respectful, reciprocal relationships” [2]. As Dunne and Raby relate, “we need more pluralism in design, not of style but of ideology and values.” [32]. Further, Arturo Escobar details, what we need is “an entire way of life and a whole style of world making” [37].

4.2 What Comes Next for Design?

There has been a large corpus of work aimed at problematizing design for liberatory means: prefigurative design [6], respectful design [98], autonomous design [37], sustainability [70, 76], design justice [23], critical approaches to design [8, 67, 92], racial justice [11, 43, 88], feminist HCI [7, 9], social justice-oriented design [30], etc.

We won’t select a single, universal method to replace HCD (and no one should). Rather, we hold that through learning about indigenous ways of designing and knowing, we can manifest better ways to design [2]. Among others, we do think the work inspired by indigenous epistemologies and ontologies such as respectful design, building in a Good Way, and autonomous design are specifically inspiring for a future of design [2, 37, 74, 94].

Indigenous ontologies are more advanced in respectfully accommodating the nonhuman, ethics, past, present, and future generations, and thus ideal for designing systems [73]. These methods align with anarchist, antiwork, and transformative justice principles, such as emphasizing locality, accountability, sovereignty, and extending the notions of who’s responsible. As Gord Hill and Allan Antliff elaborate, indigenous sovereignty is a path forward for both indigenous and non-indigenous people [57]. These ontologies are indigenous based or inspired methods, built on direct experiences of colonization [3, 98]. The term indigenous oversimplifies and aggregates different experiences of colonialism [2]. Indigenous thought itself is varied and embraces this multiplicity [73, 98].

Indigenous thought offers a way of connecting the past, present, and future: understanding the world has lived before us, that we’re only here for a short time, and the world will live beyond our life [98]. Key to this process is decentering humans as the height or center of creation [73, 74]. As Akama et al. point out, “The challenge for us now, as practitioners, researchers, and educators of design, is to carve out ways for respectful, reciprocal, and relational co-designing for social innovation that is premised upon a pluriversal view.” [2].

Beyond transforming our processes of design, what projects need to be undertaken to further the abolition of work?

5 TRANSFORMATIVE JUSTICE: A FRAMEWORK

“Peacebuilding is part of our human nature and collective memory.” – Manny Lares of Barrios Unidos [80].

Postwork literature often doesn’t give concrete directions for how to abolish work. To render these directions, we believe transformative justice is an ideal model for thinking about how we can actually abolish work. Similar to Asad’s prefigurative design, we also utilize transformative justice in a design context, only to render the goals of antiwork as a design object and structure design processes to actualize them [6]. We are also inspired by Dickinson et al. who utilized co-design to augment the transformative justice processes of street outreach workers in high violence areas in Chicago [28].

Transformative Justice (TJ) is a model of justice that has its roots in abolishing the criminal punishment system, offering a way to handle harm and violence that uses community-based, participatory methods to challenge the root cause of the harm [38, 68, 87]. TJ shifts the focus of violence from individuals to communities, as perpetrators and casualties of violence, as spaces of prevention, intervention, and transformation [68]. Key to TJ is the transformation of the “community and social conditions that create and perpetuate violence, i.e., systems of oppression, exploitation, domination, and State violence. . . must be transformed in order to achieve justice in individual instances of violence” [45].

Within this framework, structural violence is, “systematic violence of social institutions that oppress certain social groups, condemning them to abject poverty and the marginalization that accompanies severe inequality” [54]. Structural violence is “structural because they are embedded in the political and economic organization of our social world” and “violent because they cause injury to people” [38, 40]. Violence is more than physical harm, also occurring when “. . . human beings are being influenced so that their actual somatic and mental realizations are below their potential realizations” [44]. We believe work is a global form of structural violence.

TJ envisions relationships, communities, and society liberated from the intergenerational legacies of violence and colonization. It expands who is responsible for violence beyond the individual. Instead, it encompasses the individual harmed, the person causing the harm, bystanders to the violence, different collusions with power, and larger systemic conditions. This is done by creating conditions of cooperation, respect, self-determination, and equitable access to resources, while building community-based institutions operating within values and practices that make possible a world without violence [45].

TJ insists on using processes outside of the state, rather than attempting to reform it [45, 68]. The state serves to maintain the conditions of structural violence (e.g., criminal punishment system), and thus cannot be trusted to intervene in harm when it relies on harm for its own existence [45, 68]. The state is responsible for deepening poverty and widening economic inequalities, conditions

which breed reliance on work. Historically, transformative solutions are often utilized within marginalized communities outside of larger institutions, and thus highly undocumented and informal [12, 68, 86].

We also emphasize that this process be done outside the state: doing what one can, wherever one can, however one can, in a form of direct action [21]. The focus ought to be on building a set of institutions, resources, skills, and experiences that delegitimize work dominancy and change perspectives on work [46]. Justified power, then, is based on equity, cooperation, and self-determination, rather than domination, exploitation, violence, privilege, and entitlement [45]. Power is shifted from systems that maintain oppression to individuals, collectives, and community institutions that promote liberation [45].

6 HOW MIGHT WE... USE TRANSFORMATIVE JUSTICE AS A FRAMEWORK FOR THE ABOLITION OF WORK?

“...the power of design is often overestimated. Sometimes we can have more effect as citizens than as designers. Protests and boycotts can still be the most effective ways of making a point.” [32]

In this section, we'll examine work through TJ practices and offer a role for HCI within them. We adopt 5 practices from transformative justice to render the abolition of work: Naming and Defining Violence, Building Collectives, Preparation and Capacity Building, Supporting Healing, and Holding Accountability [45]. We explicitly define HCI projects at the end of each section.

6.1 Naming and Defining Work

Sharing experiences of work and naming what constitutes work is important. Given much of the work capitalism relies upon today is “invisible” (e.g., child rearing), this also involves making typically invisible work actually visible. Visible work is defined as “formal work that is authorized and documented” [4].

Many postwork visions are situated in terms of legal and waged work, neglecting the often invisible work of social reproduction, sex work, etc. [34, 55, 89]. Often, this labor is seen as infrastructure: hidden in the background and taken for granted [34, 104]. Social reproduction activities like cleaning, cooking, and childcare are undervalued and unwaged. Sex work is included within this scope, as it involves, “physical and affective labor intended to foster emotional regeneration of the workforce” [55].

For work to be abolished, it must be recognized as work. In the 1970s International Wages for Housework Campaign, campaigners demanded recognition and remuneration for the labor of caring, cleaning, and cooking [55, 84]. This campaign intended to make housework visible as a form of work via a wage to problematize and denaturalize gendered reproductive labor [55, 84].

Sex work is historically criminalized and stigmatized [55]. The adage “sex work is work” can be seen not as a valorization of labor but as a step towards rejecting work [55, 84]. At face value, it's arguing for sex work to have a similar legitimacy and respect as conventionally formal work. It's also advocating for sex work to be

socially visible as labor to problematize and denaturalize it. This is to construe sex work as work to be abolished [84].

Both social reproduction and sex work are work, and thus structured to a further emancipatory position.

We need more research making globally invisible work visible. As an example, Dhaundiyal et al. created a visualization tool that makes invisible domestic work, largely undertaken by women, visible [27]. This rendering was used to “provoke and thus enable reaction, reflection and hopefully subsequent change in the society” [27]. Another example is Turkopticon, a form of forum-based mutual aid, that enables Amazon Mechanical Turk workers to publish reviews about employers [59]. Turkopticon made visible the seemingly invisible working conditions so prevalent within digital crowd work.

6.2 Building Antiwork Collectives

“Everything worthwhile is done with other people”
-Organizer and Prison Abolitionist Mariame Kaba [39]

Large groups hold the capability to shift power relations. We should aim for a broad unified group of antiwork advocates with explicit values and commitments [45]. The goal of these collectives would be to increase the number of collectives globally. As TJ responses to violence become more popularized, we have a greater chance of transforming systemic conditions. A collective doesn't need to be a geographic entity, only a shared set of beliefs, practices, politics, experiences, or relationships which establish belonging. A common cause can sustain people towards collective action despite irreducible differences. Collectives can also protect us from targeted attacks from the state and other oppressive institutions [45].

We need collectives that share antiwork belief with intention to create the spaces necessary for liberation. As an example, the subreddit r/antiwork is growing with over 900,000 “idlers”, sharing antiwork literature, organizing workers, and sharing stories around workplace violence [93]. Another example, Turkopticon, offered a venue to build solidarity with fellow workers to pressure employers and Amazon [59]. These collective spaces have the capability to transform how we think about work. Similarly, Diamond et al found that sharing stories of street harassment on Hollaback, a platform to collect and share stories about street harassment, can shift people's cognitive and emotional orientation towards their experience by connecting it to a greater phenomenon [29]. Through connecting with others over a common cause, we can build towards a postwork world.

6.3 Preparation and Capacity Building

“Hope is a discipline” -Organizer and Prison Abolitionist Mariame Kaba [101]

Communities are lacking sufficient models to reduce reliance on work. The most popular models are provided by the state (e.g., unemployment benefits) [45]. Dominant groups within the community also have the capability to continue enacting the same power inequities that led to the conditions of violence, making the construction of models difficult [36]. Models of aid can also take forms of paternalism and saviorism [103].

Building capacity requires that these models are sustainable over time and across generations. Different communities will have different relationships to the needed resources [45].

Preparation and capacity building would mean communities having the resources to live without relying on work or the state. A global universal basic income may be considered. As Graeber notes, it might free up our time and energy to think and build in the short-term towards a world without work [51]. However, it will come with further reliance upon the state. The state could further disqualify marginalized people for access to this income.

Mutual aid is a primary example of capacity building. Mutual aid emphasizes cooperation over competition: a community-initiated effort where people take responsibility for caring for one another [69, 72, 103]. Mutual aid serves as a critique of economic and political arrangements, a form of prefigurative politics [6, 61, 65, 102, 103]. It helps meet the needs of communities while creating networks, experience, and infrastructure which create alternative futures where communities are less vulnerable to and reliant on work [100]. It decenters the narratives of formal responders and governments as saviors, and refocuses on the community [100, 103].

We believe global networks of mutual aid will enable a life without work for everyone. New models of mutual aid need to respond to the historical, cultural, population-specific experiences of the community and remain dynamic to local needs.

Examples of mutual aid include the Black Panther party's Free Breakfast for Children program [56], to mutual aid groups in response to COVID-19 [100], to Committees of Vigilance offering support to black people who fled slavery in the 19th century [61]. Queer, trans, and disabled communities also have a long history of practicing mutual aid [91, 102]. These informal networks create mechanisms to redistribute cash, groceries, protective equipment, information, and support [100]. They also offer spaces to create solidarity and generate a shared understanding of why needs aren't being met by current conditions. These systems can differ in ideology and can lead to burnout amongst organizers and volunteers, given this is typically work done outside of a normal 9-5 job [100].

Another example of building mutual aid amongst workers is Turkopticon [59]. Irani et al. created infrastructures for mutual aid, allowing social interchange and interdependency amongst Amazon Mechanical Turk workers [59].

The infrastructures we create change the relationalities possible between people [37]. We need to create infrastructures for mutual aid.

6.4 Supporting Healing

Healing from work is about gaining the sense of self and agency that a life without work makes possible [45]. Healing is needed in individuals involved in work, bystanders to the harms of work, and even the people who forced the work. By engaging with people who propagate harm in a compassionate way, we can challenge the dehumanization that is central to systems of oppression.

Looking at design's own practices, the blends of academia and industry are notorious for pro-work behaviors and attitudes. While we do have to find ways to sustain ourselves through working, we can enact small behaviors that increase our capabilities of abolishing

work in the future. We are all bystanders to each other's work practices.

We can begin changing our own attitudes and behaviors at work. Be aware while at work that you are selling your skills, body, mind, and time for a wage (or not even a wage) to get resources to survive [18, 79]. Go easy on your co-workers and don't try to compete with them [5]. Try to work a bit slower at times and encourage others to do so. Don't complain about your fellow workers to supervisors and management. If the problem is more serious, try talking to other colleagues about it. Be especially friendly to new starters and temporary workers. Take your sick and vacation days. When doing favors for people, don't hold them accountable for having to do some favor for you [18]. Sneak moments of pleasure at work, occasionally ignore your boss as mini-revolutions at the workplace. Don't work after hours. Take full breaks. We recommend "demotivational speaking", or changing minds on work, and more leisure. These are both miniature forms of healing and resistance. Smaller forms of autonomous action and social insurrection open up the channels for wider change. All of these actions vary by privilege and may not be possible in your workplace. If you're at work right now, go do something for yourself if you can.

This is the base of any sort of healing from work, starting in the minutiae of our day-to-day life and slowly shifting towards larger changes.

Reduce your work, change your attitude towards work, and change other's minds about work.

6.5 Holding Accountability for Those Who Enforce Work

TJ seeks forms of accountability that can enable transformation of the conditions that lead to violence, rather than utilizing accountability as a tool for punishment [45]. For those responsible for violence, being accountable gives them a way of holding onto their humanity and offering them ways to change. How do we humanize those who cause harm, and thereby allow them to humanize themselves?

When seeking accountability, a community needs leverage (a person's relationships, money, reputation, etc.) to hold a person accountable. Attempts to establish processes of accountability can result in more violence from those who initially caused harm. The intent is to use the least amount of force necessary when other methods aren't working to generate accountability.

Accountability often includes the relationship between the harmed and harmful, reparations, standards of process, and reviewing the plan with the harmful. Accountability also applies to bystanders and people complicit with the harm. This isn't about blaming people, but supporting people in providing the support, skills, awareness, and safety to challenge violence and change.

A general strike is a prime example of holding accountability. Withholding labor and undermining capital is the most fundamental power workers have under capitalism, creating large effects on the economy [35, 63]. Strikes are a notorious way to gain better working conditions and meet worker demands [19, 20]. Strikes don't necessarily mean standing outside a factory with a picket-sign. Workers can stop society in its tracks and choose to build something different. As an example, in 1976 workers in a UK arms

factory created “the Lucas Plan” which envisioned the restructuring of their workplace into “socially useful production” after being faced with layoffs [99].

Smaller strikes can be utilized: striking for a company to spend resources automating a certain dangerous task and striking for shorter working days with full pay (why stop at 8 hours when 0 hours is right there?). Strikes are often utilized to reform work by fighting for better working conditions, slightly increased pay, better benefits, etc. Working through reforms can legitimize the oppressive system rather than abolish it. While these may help in the short-term, strikes should orient towards the abolition of work as the end goal: reducing working hours to 0 and changing relations to resources through forms of mutual aid. We call for one last strike: a global strike to abolish work.

We need scalable, effective ways to strike and other forms of holding accountability.

7 JOBS TO BE DONE: TRANSFORMING NECESSARY WORK AS A FUTURE FOR DESIGN

“...the contemporary world can be considered a massive design failure, certainly the result of particular design decisions, is it a matter of designing our way out?” [37]

It’s hard to even imagine a world without work, it’s so entrenched in our minds [41]. Work culture distorts our view of unpaid activity as negative: if it’s not serving market interests or somehow improving marketable skills, it’s seen as bad. What sort of social arrangements could we create or re-create without work constantly draining our lives [52]? We believe that speculative design and a plurality of perspectives will play an important role in how we articulate workless futures together [32, 58].

As we’re dismantling work and building capacity for transformative justice, what is deemed socially necessary work will become clearer. This is subsistence work, like growing food or providing healthcare. This work needs to be rendered as “play”, done voluntarily, or:

“...activities which are... intrinsically gratifying play yet which, in their totality, produce the means of life for all. The most necessary functions such as those of the “primary sector” (food production) already have their ludic counterparts in hunting and gardening, in hobbies.” [14].

How do we transform these necessary tasks into play? In future work, we’ll elaborate on how this design process might be undertaken.

8 CONCLUSION: THE FUTURE OF WORK ISN’T WORKING

We hope to reorient the future of work beyond current trends: better ways to work remotely or automate your desk job. Instead, we hope to build towards a future of no work. We believe that HCI practitioners can contribute to the abolition of work through prefigurative politics and transformative design practices. In the future, we will render what subsistence work we need into play

using methods inspired by indigenous and prefigurative methods of design.

Designers of the world... relax!

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